

FIXED INCOME HOUSING CHECKLIST

What to ask before you sign anything

Not every place renting to people on a fixed income has your best interest in mind. Before you sign a lease or hand over a deposit anywhere, ask these questions — print this out and bring it with you.

MONEY QUESTIONS

- ☐ Is there a security deposit? How much, and is it refundable?
- ☐ Are utilities included, or billed separately?
- ☐ Is there an application fee? Is it refundable if I'm denied?
- ☐ Is a credit check required? What score do I need?
- ☐ Are there any other fees not mentioned upfront (admin fees, key fees, etc.)?

LEASE TERMS

- ☐ Is this a lease or a month-to-month agreement?
- ☐ What is the notice period if I need to leave?
- ☐ Can the rent be raised? How much notice would I get?
- ☐ What exactly happens if a payment is late?

LIVING SITUATION

- ☐ Am I renting a private room, or a shared room?
- ☐ How many people share a bathroom?
- ☐ Is furniture included, or do I need to bring my own?
- ☐ Is there a house manager or on-site staff?
- ☐ What are the guest policies?

SAFETY & TRUST

- ☐ Can I see the actual room before I commit, not just photos?
- ☐ Can I talk to a current resident?
- ☐ Is there a guarantee if it turns out not to be the right fit?
- ☐ What happens to my deposit or first payment if I change my mind?

A good sign: a place that answers every one of these questions clearly, without hesitation, before you've paid anything. A red flag: pressure to sign or pay before you've gotten straight answers to all of the above.

Want the answers to all of these, right now?
Call New Creation Living: (404) 731-2371

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